F-1 Student Visa Interview

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F-1 applicants are interviewed by a consular officer at a U.S. embassy or consulate after being accepted by a SEVP-certified school and receiving a Form I-20.

Key facts from official sources

- Students must be accepted by a school certified by the Student and Exchange Visitor Program (SEVP), which issues Form I-20. [Source 2]
- Most F-1 applicants pay the SEVIS I-901 fee and complete the online DS-160 visa application before the interview; check the embassy's instructions. [Source 1]

Commonly reported practice questions

Commonly reported practice questions: these are general topics people report being asked about. They are NOT an official USCIS or Department of State list. Officers may ask anything related to your case. Answer truthfully and consistently with your forms.

- Why you chose this school and program.
- How the program fits your studies and career plans.
- How you will pay for tuition and living costs.
- Your academic background and test scores.
- Your plans after you finish your studies.

Document checklist

Always follow the list on your own interview notice or embassy instructions first.

☐ Valid passport

☐ Form I-20 signed by you and your school

☐ DS-160 confirmation page

☐ Interview appointment confirmation and fee receipt

☐ SEVIS I-901 fee payment confirmation

☐ Financial evidence (bank statements, scholarship letters, sponsor documents)

☐ Academic transcripts, diplomas and test scores

Interview day tips

- Answer briefly and clearly in your own words.
- Know your program details and costs.

- Bring organized financial documents.

Stay organized

Keep your documents and deadlines in one place with PathwayUS, an organizing tool (not legal help): mypathwayusa.com/landing

Sources

1 U.S. Department of State: Student Visa: https://travel.state.gov/content/travel/en/us-visas/study/student-visa.html

2 DHS: Study in the States: https://studyinthestates.dhs.gov/

Contact: pnsglobalIlc@gmail.com · Sources checked 2026-10-16. Practice questions are general and not official.